BDC business plan template for entrepreneurs

Instructions

1. The template is provided as a reference only. Not all sections will be relevant for your company; you may need to modify them substantially to respond to your needs.
2. Ideas for what to write were provided (in red) for every section. Delete this page and the instructions provided in every section before finalizing your business plan.
3. The BDC business plan template was created using Microsoft Word software. You may encounter formatting and other problems if you are using different software.
4. Write simply and concisely. Consider using bullets instead of paragraphs.
5. It is best to avoid repetition, if possible.
6. Your business plan is not a static document. You must review it regularly and adjust it to reflect changing conditions.

Your Logo

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Executive summary

Currently, the exterior maintenance market in London, Ontario is dominated by two main competitors, Student Works and Gutter Guys. These companies operate with complex organizational structures and heavy corporate overhead, including expensive franchise fees and multiple layers of management. Consequently, they are often forced to charge higher prices to cover these significant operational costs. Core Exterior takes a different approach by utilizing a streamlined and efficient business model that removes unnecessary expenses. This lean structure allows us to offer more competitive pricing than the market leaders without compromising on the quality of service we provide to our residential and commercial clients in the Greater London Area.

Project objectives

Nature of the Project Core Exterior is a locally owned and operated landscaping and exterior maintenance firm serving London, Ontario. Now entering our second year of operation, the business has evolved from a grassroots neighborhood service into a fully structured enterprise. We are dedicated to providing efficient, high-quality, and fair-priced exterior cleaning solutions, bridging the gap between casual labor and expensive corporate franchises.

Market Opportunity We intend to capture market share currently dominated by a functional duopoly of two major competitors. These incumbents are burdened by high corporate overhead and rigid organizational structures, resulting in inflated premiums and inconsistent quality standards for the consumer. Core Exterior disrupts this model by maintaining a lean, low-overhead structure. This efficiency allows us to offer superior quality to both residential homeowners and commercial clients (including malls, retail shops, and community centers) at a significantly more competitive price point.

Our objective is to maximize seasonal capacity through a phased talent acquisition and "Spring Launch" strategy.

- **Phase 1: Leadership & Sales Recruitment (February)**
  - **February 14th: We will finalize the leadership structure by onboarding 3-4 Territory Managers to oversee regional operations.**
  - **February 24th: We will recruit a sales force of approximately 40 Client Acquisition Specialists. This team will focus on direct sales, lead generation, and territory mapping.**
- **Phase 2: Sales Launch (March)**
  - **March 7th: The sales force initiates the "Spring Launch" with aggressive direct outreach and cold sales to build the initial project pipeline.**
- **Phase 3: Service Fulfillment & Digital Optimization (April - May)**
  - **April 4th: We will onboard 8 Field Restoration Technicians, organized into 4 specialized Service Deployment Units. This ensures we have the labor capacity to execute the contracts secured in March.**

    - **April - May: We will launch a targeted Digital Marketing Campaign designed to capture online search traffic. This serves as a "Capacity Optimization" tool, specifically targeted to fill any scheduling gaps left by the direct sales team.**
- **Financial Objectives:**
    - **We project reaching a break-even point within the first month of active service.**
    - **Our primary goal is to scale operations rapidly to achieve $250,000 in gross revenue by the end of the fiscal season.**
- **Operational Window: Service execution will run continuously through August 28th, capitalizing on the peak demand for spring cleaning and summer maintenance.**

Business description

Company Location and History : Core Exterior is headquartered at 203 Cambridge Street in London, Ontario and serves the entire Greater Middlesex County area including St. Thomas, Strathroy, and Dorchester. Now entering our second year of operation, the company was born from a grassroots initiative where we initially provided complimentary power washing services to neighbors. This commitment to quality work quickly generated strong word-of-mouth referrals which necessitated immediate investment in professional-grade equipment such as industrial ladders and high-performance pressure washers. What began as a residential service has since evolved into a scalable enterprise after we identified significant demand from commercial sectors including condominiums and shopping malls which sought our high-quality solutions at a fair price.

Solutions Provided: We provide a complete range of exterior maintenance solutions designed to revitalize property aesthetics and ensure structural longevity. Our services include soft washing for vinyl siding to eliminate mold and algae, power washing for driveways to remove hazardous biological buildup, gutter cleaning for efficient water flow, and hardscape restoration such as interlock leveling. In the current real estate market, these services represent a crucial financial investment for our clients. Research from the University of Alabama indicates that high curb appeal can increase a home's sale price by 7%, while studies from Virginia Tech suggest that enhanced exterior aesthetics can boost perceived property value by nearly 13%. By delivering professional restoration, Core Exterior ensures homeowners maximize this equity while maintaining a safe and clean environment.

Market Fit and Competitive Advantage: Core Exterior positions itself as a competitive alternative to the existing market duopoly by offering pricing that is approximately 20% lower than competitors like Student Works. We achieve this price advantage by maintaining a lean organizational structure that eliminates the inflated overhead and franchise fees of the larger firms. This value proposition is critical in the current London real estate climate where high inventory levels have created a competitive environment. Recent data for the London-St. Thomas market shows a sales-to-new-listings ratio of just 49%, meaning roughly half of all newly listed homes do not sell immediately. This pressure forces homeowners to prioritize exterior maintenance to differentiate their properties. We capture this essential demand within the growing $83 billion Canadian home improvement market by providing the reliability and warranty of a large firm at a price point accessible to the average homeowner.

Current Major Initiatives: Our primary operational initiative is the digitization of our workflow to enhance efficiency and customer experience. We are currently transitioning from pen-and-paper estimates to a sophisticated digital CRM system that allows for instant quotes and digital contract signing on-site. This system integrates directly with our scheduling software to provide our territory managers with real-time calendar visibility for optimized crew deployment. Simultaneously,

we are scaling our workforce by hiring territory managers and a dedicated sales team in February followed by the deployment of specialized labor technicians in April to meet our projected seasonal demand.

Products and services

Service Offerings Core Exterior provides a comprehensive suite of maintenance solutions designed to preserve property value and enhance curb appeal.

Wood Restoration and Deck Maintenance We offer complete deck restoration services, including power washing, sanding, and staining. This process returns weathered wood to a "like-new" condition and protects it from the elements, significantly extending the lifespan of the structure without the expense of full replacement.

Hardscape Optimization (Interlock & Polymeric Sand) For patios, driveways, and walkways, we provide specialized interlock leveling and polymeric sand installation. This formulated blend fills joints between pavers to create a stable, long-lasting bond that resists erosion, prevents weed growth, and corrects uneven surfaces caused by frost heave.

Exterior Siding Cleaning We utilize a dual-method approach for building exteriors, employing both standard power washing and specialized "soft washing" techniques. This allows us to safely remove dirt, grime, grease, mildew, and mold from vinyl and other delicate surfaces without causing structural damage.

Gutter & Eavestrough Maintenance Our gutter service focuses on preventative care by removing lodged debris from gutters and downspouts. This ensures increased flow rates and prevents water from backing up and freezing, which can lead to expensive crack repairs or replacement.

Window Cleaning Technicians treat the entire window assembly, including panes, frames, mechanisms, tracks, storm windows, and screens. We also lubricate the tracks to ensure smooth operation, providing both exterior and interior cleaning services.

Landscaping and Garden Finishing We provide essential garden bed maintenance including professional mulching and weed removal. These finishing touches enhance the visual contrast of the landscape while promoting soil health by retaining moisture and suppressing future weed growth.

Revenue Breakdown Our projected revenue streams are diversified across high-margin restoration projects and recurring maintenance services:

- **Deck Restoration:** Represents **25%** of revenue, driven by high material margins and labor value.
- **Interlock Leveling & Sanding:** Represents **25%** of revenue, capitalizing on the high demand for hardscape repair in London.
- **Siding Cleaning:** Accounts for **15%** of overall revenue.
- **Gutter & Eavestrough Cleaning:** Accounts for **15%** of overall revenue.
- **Window Cleaning:** Represents **10%** of revenue.
- **General Landscaping (Mulching/Weeding):** Accounts for the final **10%** of revenue, often sold as an add-on service.

Financing need

Core Exterior has successfully completed its **Market Validation Phase** (Summer 2025).

Operating strictly through an organic word-of-mouth network of friends, family, and neighbors in the London area, the team executed **26 residential projects** in short amount of time from **May to June**. Despite having **zero marketing budget** during this pilot phase, we generated approximately **$9,700 in gross turnover**.

This pilot season serves as our "proof of concept." We achieved nearly $10,000 in revenue simply by servicing our immediate community. This organic success demonstrates a clear, unaddressed demand for our services. It indicates that if we can achieve these results through passive referrals, we can exponentially scale our revenue by applying a structured marketing strategy to the broader London market.

2. How much money do you require for your project?

We are seeking a seed investment of **$10,000**.

Because we acquired significant assets during our pilot phase, our capital requirements are lower than a typical construction startup. This funding is strictly focused on legal compliance, cash flow stability, and aggressive customer acquisition rather than heavy asset purchases.

3. How do you plan on investing the money?

We have allocated the $10,000 into three strategic buckets to ensure we are fully compliant and operational by the start of the season:

- **40% — Operational Setup & Customer Acquisition ($4,000):** This capital is necessary to legitimize the business structure and transition from "word-of-mouth" to consistent inbound sales.
    - **Legal & Compliance:** Costs include business registration, mandatory **WSIB coverage**, and comprehensive Commercial General Liability (CGL) insurance to protect the company and clients.
    - **Marketing:** Launching a targeted local campaign including lawn signage in high-income neighborhoods and digital lead generation to secure our first 10 major contracts of the season.
- **40% — Working Capital & Float ($4,000):** Construction management requires a healthy cash "float" to operate smoothly.
    - **Liquidity:** This fund will bridge the critical gap between weekly labor payouts to our sub-crews and the net-30 payment terms often required by larger clients. It ensures we can accept larger contracts without facing cash flow shortages during the project.
- **20% — Equipment Upgrades & Maintenance ($2,000):**
    - **Capital Efficiency:** We are maximizing the value of the equipment inventory acquired during our pilot year (pressure washers, basic ladders, hand tools), which drastically reduces our startup costs.
    - **Strategic Upgrades:** This budget is reserved strictly for necessary replacements and specialized upgrades—such as safety harnesses and longer extension ladders—that allow us to bid on higher-value, multi-story projects that we previously had to decline.

Key people

Executive Leadership and Advisors The strategic direction of Core Exterior is led by **Luke Cairns**, who serves as the Founder and CEO. He is supported by **Mirkomil Oblokulov**, the Senior Manager responsible for overseeing the operational bridge between sales and labor crews. Additionally, the company benefits from the mentorship of **David Proudfoot**, a Senior Business Advisor and Program Coordinator at the London Small Business Centre, who provides external strategic guidance.

Relevant Experience The leadership team brings proven market validation to the company. Luke Cairns successfully founded and managed "Oakwood Home Services" during a pilot project in Summer 2025. In just six weeks, he oversaw twenty-six residential contracts and generated nearly ten thousand dollars in revenue with zero initial funding. This experience provided hands-on expertise in project estimation, material procurement, and sub-trade negotiation. Currently pursuing a Business degree at Western University, Luke applies academic financial acumen to manage cash flow and margins effectively. Together with Mirkomil Oblokulov, the team has demonstrated the ability to bootstrap operations and drive organic growth.

Organizational Structure and Current Responsibilities Core Exterior operates on a tiered management system designed for scalability, ensuring that responsibilities are strictly divided to maximize efficiency.

Tier 1: Executive Strategy Luke Cairns (CEO) focuses on compliance and finance. He manages the seed fund and strictly controls the cash float to ensure all labor technicians are paid on time while managing client receivables, WSIB, and insurance liabilities. He also directs the macro-marketing efforts that support the ground sales team. **Mirkomil Oblokulov (Senior Manager)** acts as the operational hub connecting executive vision with field execution. He conducts mandatory weekly strategy reviews with middle managers to identify performance issues, such as low sales conversion or stalled job sites, and implements immediate corrective measures.

Tier 2: Middle Management The company employs Territory and Quality Managers who are responsible for the physical inspection of job sites. Their role ensures that Labour Technicians adhere to strict safety standards and installation quality. They also handle asset management, organizing trailers, brakes, and ladders daily to ensure crews have necessary materials and zero production time is wasted.

Tier 3: The Field Force The workforce is divided into two specialized units. **Sales Technicians** focus purely on high-volume acquisition. Their responsibility is to canvass neighborhoods and feed a constant stream of qualified quotes to the management team. **Labour Technicians** are focused strictly on execution and speed. Selected for their proficiency in exterior systems, they focus one hundred percent on physical installation to ensure projects are completed within estimated timelines.

Risk assessment and contingency plan

Internal Weaknesses and External Threats The most significant internal risk to our business model is the potential for cash flow instability caused by cash float gaps. With a staff of over thirty employees, we face substantial weekly payroll obligations that cannot wait for delayed client payments. To secure our liquidity, we strictly enforce a mandatory **25% upfront deposit** on all contracts. This policy effectively locks in the customer to prevent them from shopping around while providing immediate funds to cover sales commissions without depleting our operating capital. Externally, we must navigate London's variable weather and the municipal Water By-law W-8 which restricts summer water use. We manage this through a smart-scheduling system that aligns bookings with the city's alternating-day allowances, booking odd-numbered addresses on odd days and even-numbered addresses on even days. While our standard production week runs Monday through Saturday, we reserve Sunday strictly as an **Emergency Makeup Day** to recover any production time lost to rain without disrupting the wider schedule.

Skilled Labor and Workforce Retention We operate in a sector known for high turnover and have developed specific protocols to retain both labor and sales staff. The physical demands of exterior maintenance often lead to labor burnout, so unlike competitors who push crews to work seven days a week, we enforce a mandatory **Sunday Rest Day** to ensure work-life balance. We also offer an **End-of-Season Bonus** to incentivize technicians to complete the full contract term. On the sales side, direct acquisition roles often suffer from attrition due to delayed gratification. We have countered this by shifting to an **Instant Commission** model where we utilize the customer's upfront deposit to pay sales agents their commission immediately upon signing. This financial immediacy keeps the sales force motivated and significantly reduces the turnover rate seen in previous seasons.

Competitive Defense Strategy A persistent threat in our market comes from unregistered independent operators who avoid WSIB and insurance costs to undercut pricing by roughly twenty to thirty percent. We defend our market share by positioning Core Exterior as the safe and compliant choice. We actively educate homeowners on the significant financial liability they assume by hiring uninsured workers who lack proper coverage. Furthermore, our 25% deposit strategy financially commits the customer to us early in the buying process. This creates a psychological and financial lock-in that neutralizes the threat of them canceling for a cheaper, riskier alternative later in the season.

Regulatory Compliance and Consumer Protection Our direct sales model is subject to the Ontario Consumer Protection Act, specifically the mandatory **10-day cooling-off period** for direct agreements. This creates a risk where we might deploy resources to a job that is legally cancelable. To manage this, we utilize digital contracts that clearly outline consumer rights and have implemented a **Safe Scheduling** protocol. Our system automatically blocks labor dispatch until the eleventh day after signing unless a specific waiver is executed. This ensures we never expend labor hours or materials on a project that is still within the cancellation window.

Monitoring and Response Framework We employ a dual-track system to monitor these risks and ensure our mitigation strategies are effective. Financially, the 25% deposit serves as our primary shield, covering the Customer Acquisition Cost instantly so that we never fund sales commissions out-of-pocket for unverified revenue. Operationally, we closely track crew burnout by monitoring weekly output metrics. If quality or speed dips, we strictly enforce the Sunday Rest Day to ensure the team recovers, protecting our long-term production capacity throughout the summer season.

01.

Business overview

Core Exterior is a London, Ontario-based property maintenance firm specializing in residential and commercial exterior restoration, including power washing, gutter cleaning, and hardscape repair. We operate within the eighty-three billion dollar Canadian home improvement market, serving a specific niche of homeowners and property managers who require professional reliability without the inflated premiums of franchise competitors. Our competitive advantage lies in a lean operational structure that eliminates the heavy corporate overhead typical of the market duopoly, allowing us to offer comparable quality and full insurance compliance at a price point approximately twenty percent lower than industry leaders. We strictly adhere to municipal water bylaws and provincial safety regulations, leveraging modern digital CRM technology and a compliant direct sales model to capture significant market share in the Greater London Area.

Business description

Solutions and Value Proposition Core Exterior provides more than just cleaning; we deliver property compliance, full liability insurance, and professional project management to mitigate risk for our clients. Our services are often driven by the homeowner's need to prepare their property for guests, such as our window cleaning program which restores glass to a pristine condition for social events. Crucially, we prioritize safety by removing slippery algae buildup from wooden decks to prevent slip-and-fall accidents. We also undertake high-risk work that homeowners cannot safely perform themselves, such as servicing third-story gutters and eavestroughs. This ensures the property is maintained without the homeowner ever having to climb a ladder, combining high-quality results with strict safety adherence.

Market Trends and Competitive Fit The company is currently on an aggressive but steady upward trajectory, having expanded to a workforce of over thirty employees to meet seasonal demand. We fit into the market as the strategic middle ground between expensive franchise operators and unreliable budget labor. Unlike competitors such as Student Works or College Pro, where a significant portion of revenue is lost to franchise fees, our operation is entirely locally owned. Because we do not pay these external corporate royalties, we can retain earnings for reinvestment and keep pricing fair while still offering the professional management structure that clients expect.

Current Major Initiatives Our current operational initiatives focus on increasing efficiency through technology. We are integrating artificial intelligence tools to analyze neighborhood demographics, which helps us identify the most productive zones for our door-to-door sales teams to canvass. Simultaneously, we are refining our digital marketing strategy by leveraging Google Analytics to optimize our ad spend. These initiatives are designed to modernize our workflow, moving away from intuition-based decisions to a data-driven model that lowers our customer acquisition cost.

Company Location and History Core Exteriors is headquartered in London, Ontario, and provides comprehensive service coverage to the entire Greater London Area. Now entering our second year, the business has undergone a radical transformation based on critical operational learnings from our first season. Initially, a single manager handled sales, marketing, labor, and finances, which inevitably led to administrative errors like double-booking and oversight. We have since restructured to specialized roles to eliminate these issues. We also learned vital lessons regarding equipment and integrity; after dealing with frequent hose failures and an incident of internal theft, we have upgraded to industrial-grade equipment like X-jet nozzles and implemented strict financial controls alongside a rigorous vetting process to ensure we only employ trusted, high-integrity staff.

Mission, vision, values

Core Exterior is a dedicated student-led venture committed to delivering elite property maintenance services to the London community. Our mission is to combine professional-grade standards with a relentless work ethic to restore and protect the value of our clients' homes. We pride ourselves on providing transparent, fair pricing while actively reinvesting in our city by employing local students and fostering a culture of local excellence.

Our vision is to become the most trusted and cost-effective provider of exterior property care in Southwestern Ontario. By leveraging our academic background in finance and economics, we are building a robust, system-driven business model designed to solve common industry pain points—such as unreliable scheduling and inconsistent customer service—to ensure operational efficiency and long-term scalability.

At the core of our operations are four key values: **Punctuality, Integrity, Transparency, and Community.** We respect our customers' time by maintaining strict schedules and professional organization. We operate on a "job-complete" guarantee, refusing to leave a site until the results meet our high-quality standards. Furthermore, we maintain 100% pricing transparency to build lasting trust with homeowners, all while supporting the local student economy through meaningful employment and mentorship.

Industry overview and trends

London, Ontario, is currently one of the fastest-growing metropolitan areas in Canada, with a population recently reaching approximately 510,000 [World Population Review, 2026]. This rapid growth has transformed the housing market; over the last 25 years, home prices in the London region have more than tripled, rising from an average of $127,261 in 1996 to over $630,000 today [CBC News; LSTAR Stats]. This massive appreciation means homeowners are more motivated than ever to invest in "curb appeal" to protect their significant financial investments.

The demographic landscape in London is also shifting in a way that favors professional maintenance services. Approximately 17.8% of London’s population is now aged 65 or older [Statistics Canada, 2021 Census]. As this senior population grows, there is a rising demand for "Do-It-For-Me" services, as many older residents can no longer safely use ladders for gutter cleaning or roof maintenance. Furthermore, the younger generation of homeowners often lacks the "hands-on" tools or time for high-intensity exterior cleaning, creating a significant "service gap" in the local market.

On the commercial side, London’s economy is booming with major industrial developments, such as the upcoming Volkswagen EV battery plant in St. Thomas, which is expected to create up to 3,000 direct jobs and thousands more in the supply chain by 2027 [City of London Economic Profile]. This industrial expansion, alongside the continued development of new malls and office complexes, has increased the need for pristine commercial exteriors.

Technological advancements are also making the industry more efficient and cost-effective. At Core Exterior, we utilize modern technology like water-fed pole systems, which allow us to clean windows and siding more safely and quickly than traditional squeegee methods, reducing labor costs while increasing quality. While small student-run competitors exist, such as DosBros Pressure Washing, they often lack the scale and formal business structure required for larger contracts. Core Exterior is positioning itself as a leader by scaling our labor force and ensuring full compliance with professional standards, including carrying proper liability insurance and HST registration. We also prioritize environmental responsibility by adhering to municipal water-use guidelines, such as following the City of London’s "even/odd" day watering protocols (W-8 By-law) to ensure sustainable and legal operations during peak summer months.

Technological trends

The exterior maintenance industry is currently undergoing a digital and technical transformation. A major disruption is the move away from manual "pen-and-paper" operations toward **Customer Relationship Management (CRM)** systems. A CRM is a digital platform that centralizes all customer data, allowing us to track every interaction from the initial quote to the final invoice. By moving to a digital-first model, we eliminate the risk of lost paperwork and significantly improve communication speed.

Core Exterior is staying ahead of these trends by integrating advanced hardware and custom software solutions. We have moved away from traditional squeegees and manual gutter cleaning in favor of **water-fed pole systems** and **custom-engineered gutter vacuums**. These technologies allow our crews to clean windows and remove debris from the ground, drastically increasing safety and reducing the time spent on each job.

To maintain our competitive edge, we are developing our own **internal CRM system** tailored specifically to our high-speed operational workflow. We also hold weekly innovation sessions every Sunday where our management team reviews the past week's performance to identify technical bottlenecks. This has already led us to phase out retail-grade equipment in favor of **specialized nozzles** and industrial-grade power washers. As we scale into larger commercial properties, we plan to upgrade to high-PSI, high-flow units with longer, professional-grade hoses. To protect these assets, all equipment is housed in a secure storage unit where managers perform weekly "tune-ups," including oil changes and pump inspections, to ensure zero downtime during the work week.

Our customer experience is designed to be almost entirely digital, meeting the expectations of today’s homeowners. We utilize **E-signatures for all contracts**, delivering documents directly to the client’s email for instant approval. While we provide clients with a direct line to our managers for 24/7 text or call support, our digital back-end ensures that all schedules and project updates are tracked in real-time. This blend of high-tech hardware and digital communication allows Core Exterior to operate with the precision of a large firm while maintaining the agility of a student-led venture.

Government regulations

Operating a professional property maintenance company in London involves navigating several provincial and municipal frameworks that ensure safety and legal integrity. While the industry is not as strictly regulated as sectors like healthcare, staying compliant is a core part of how Core Exterior maintains its professional reputation.

A primary focus for the business is staying in line with the Ontario Employment Standards Act, particularly concerning the compensation of the student team. Because the business utilizes a commission and bonus structure, it is essential to ensure that every worker is guaranteed the provincial minimum wage of $17.60 per hour. If performance-based earnings don't reach that threshold for the hours worked, the business provides a top-up to meet the legal requirement. This also includes the mandatory 4% vacation pay on all commissions. By using clear, written agreements that define a commission as earned only once the customer has paid in full, the company maintains a transparent and fair relationship with its staff.

At the local level, Core Exterior coordinates its services with the City of London’s Water By-law W-8. This means scheduling power washing and window cleaning to align with the city's even and odd day watering protocols during the summer months. To operate legally within the city, the business maintains a Municipal Contractor Business License, which requires holding at least $2,000,000 in commercial general liability insurance and staying in good standing with the Workplace Safety and Insurance Board. These measures provide a safety net for both the student workers and the homeowners who trust the company with their properties.

Beyond local rules, international trade and environmental standards play a role in the company's overhead and impact. The Canada-United States-Mexico Agreement is vital for sourcing high-performance equipment like industrial pumps and X-Jet nozzles from American manufacturers without excessive duty costs. From an environmental standpoint, all cleaning agents used are phosphate-free and biodegradable, meeting the standards of the Ontario Environmental Protection Act and federal regulations on phosphorus concentrations. This ensures that any runoff from a job site is safe for London's ecosystem. Finally, as the business scales, it closely monitors the $30,000 revenue threshold set by the Canada Revenue Agency to ensure timely registration and collection of HST.

The market

Overview of market trends

The exterior maintenance industry in London has evolved from a fragmented market of general handymen into a specialized sector dominated by professional firms. Currently, major entities like Student Works and Gutter Guys account for roughly 70% of the local market share, reflecting a broader trend where homeowners prefer specialized experts over general contractors. A significant shift in the industry is the rise of preventative products such as gutter guards, which have changed the supply chain and service offerings by allowing companies to provide long-term protection rather than just reactive cleaning. Core Exterior is entering this market at a time when London is experiencing historic expansion. As one of the fastest-growing cities in Ontario with a population growth rate of 1.6% for 2026, the city is seeing massive residential development in high-income pockets like Masonville in the north and Lambeth in the south [City of London Economic Profile]. These areas are characterized by a high density of single-detached homes part of the 122,265 detached dwellings in the London region which represent the core of our residential service opportunities [Statistics Canada, 2021 Census].

Our target audience consists of upper-middle-income households and commercial entities that view property maintenance as a non-negotiable investment. We specifically focus on the older demographic in London, as residents aged 65 and older now make up nearly 18% of the local population [Statistics Canada, 2021 Census]. While these homeowners have historically been more hands-on, they are increasingly reaching an age where climbing ladders and performing physical labor is no longer safe or practical. Conversely, the younger generation moving into new developments in areas like Lambeth often lacks the specialized technical skills and industrial equipment required to maintain these modern properties to an elite standard. This creates a significant gap in the market for a system driven company that can provide reliable, high-quality results for a generation that is more willing to pay for professional expertise than to attempt a DIY approach.

Beyond personal preference, regulatory and legal factors are increasingly influencing the necessity of our services. Under the City of London Property Standards By-law CP-24, homeowners are legally required to keep their structures in a state of good repair, which includes maintaining clean gutters and debris-free exteriors to prevent structural decay [City of London, 2024]. Furthermore, as home values in London have surged tripling over the last 25 years insurance providers have become more stringent [LSTAR]. Many insurers now require proof of regular maintenance, such as gutter clearing, to uphold water damage coverage. These regulations and financial pressures mean that for our target customers, hiring Core Exterior is not just a luxury, but a strategic move to ensure legal compliance and protect their most significant financial asset.

Target market

Our residential focus is on higher middle income single parents and older residents who prioritize their home value but face significant time and safety barriers. These homeowners often fear the physical risks of climbing ladders and require an honest service provider who will not overcharge for basic maintenance. We see a clear shift in behavior where these clients prefer supporting independent student ventures over large corporate franchises like Student Works or Gutter Guys. Because we are actual students run by students, customers recognize that our prices are more affordable since we do not pass on the cost of heavy corporate franchise fees.

On the commercial side, our ideal customers are property managers and business owners who oversee retail plazas and office complexes in London. Their primary need is a reliable partner who maintains a pristine exterior to attract tenants and customers without requiring constant oversight. These commercial clients are increasingly focused on cost efficiency and value the social impact of hiring local Western University students. By operating as an independent student venture, we provide the professional reliability they demand at a competitive price point that avoids the typical corporate markup.

Products and services

Core Exterior generates revenue through a focused mix of specialized cleaning and restoration services that target the specific needs of property owners in London. Based on the data from the pilot phase where twenty six projects were completed for a total revenue of nine thousand seven hundred dollars the breakdown across categories is clear. Deck restoration is one of the most significant earners contributing two thousand four hundred and twenty five dollars which represents twenty five percent of the total revenue. This high value is driven by the intensive labor required for sanding and staining as well as the healthy margins on the materials used for these projects. Interlock leveling and sanding matches this performance also contributing twenty five percent of the revenue at two thousand four hundred and twenty five dollars as it meets a strong demand for hardscape repair in local neighborhoods.

The maintenance side of the business provides a consistent flow of income with siding cleaning and gutter maintenance each accounting for fifteen percent of the total revenue. These services each brought in one thousand four hundred and fifty five dollars during the pilot period. Window cleaning represents ten percent of the revenue share totaling nine hundred and seventy dollars while general landscaping tasks such as mulching and weeding contribute the final ten percent also amounting to nine hundred and seventy dollars. These landscaping jobs are often utilized as effective add on services to increase the overall value of a single site visit.

The service model is designed to fill a gap in the market where there is a noticeable lack of skilled labor for technical jobs like deck sanding and staining. By training staff to handle these specific tasks the business provides a level of craftsmanship that generalist companies cannot easily replicate. Looking forward the service list is set to evolve through the integration of new technology and artificial intelligence to improve work efficiency. The management stays connected with new startups to find better ways to streamline these processes and ensure that Core Exterior remains more efficient and more affordable than the larger corporate franchises that are burdened by heavy fees.

The competition

Competitors and types of competition & Competitors’ strengths and weaknesses

Direct Competitors

These companies provide identical services (pressure washing, window cleaning, and gutter maintenance) and are your primary rivals for local residential contracts.

1. **Student Works Window Cleaning:** A large franchise that uses student managers to provide seasonal exterior cleaning across London.
2. **College Pro:** Similar to Student Works, they focus on student-led window and gutter cleaning services with heavy neighborhood flyering.
3. **Shack Shine London:** A premium franchise specializing in "house detailing," offering bundled window, gutter, and power washing services.
4. **Bear Property Cleaning:** A locally-owned specialist known for high-end "soft washing" techniques for siding and roofs.
5. **London Cleaners:** An established local firm that provides all-in-one exterior maintenance with a focus on 100% satisfaction guarantees.

Indirect Competitors

These businesses solve the same core problem—maintaining the home's appearance or preventing damage—but through different services or methods.

1. **London Property Solutions (Landscaping):** While they focus on lawns, they often offer "quick spray-downs" of siding or driveways as an add-on.
2. **Davidoff Roofing:** Their primary business is roofing, but they compete for gutter cleaning leads when homeowners look for water-damage prevention.
3. **The Home Depot (DIY Rental):** By offering pressure washer rentals for $60–$80/day, they compete for customers who choose to do the labor themselves.
4. **Enviroblitz:** Primarily an interior cleaning company that offers basic exterior window cleaning, capturing customers who prefer a single "inside-out" provider.
5. **Local General Handymen:** Independent contractors who include gutter clearing or porch washing as part of a larger list of home repairs.

The Core Exterior Competitive Edge

The primary differentiator for **Core Exterior** lies in our independent, student-owned business model. Unlike franchise competitors like **Student Works** or **College Pro**, we do not pay corporate royalty fees, which typically drain **30% to 50%** of a student manager’s profit. By eliminating these franchise fees, Core Exterior can reinvest that capital directly into higher-grade professional equipment and more thorough service, or offer more competitive pricing to the homeowner

while maintaining higher profit margins. This lean structure allows us to provide the "support-a-student" value that London residents appreciate, without the corporate overhead that often inflates franchise pricing.

Industry Disruption and Future Threats

The exterior cleaning industry is currently being disrupted by emerging technologies that aim to replace traditional manual labor with automation.

- **Cleaning Drones:** Companies like **Lucid Bots** (and operators like **Reliable Cleaning Services** in Ontario) are deploying drones to clean windows and siding on multi-story homes. These drones remove the need for ladders, significantly reducing safety risks and labor time.
- **Robotic Window Cleaners:** Products such as the **Mova** or **Ozmo** by Skyline Robotics are designed to clean glass autonomously. While currently more common in commercial sectors, they are rapidly moving into the high-end residential market.
- **Self-Cleaning Materials:** The increasing use of **hydrophobic coatings** on new siding and windows means dirt and organic growth (mold/algae) cannot easily stick to surfaces, potentially extending the time between professional cleanings from one year to three or more.
- **Smart DIY Equipment:** New electric, AI-optimized pressure washers are becoming more affordable and easier to use, which may encourage more homeowners to choose the DIY route over hiring a professional service.

Competitive advantage and differentiator

What would make customers choose your product or service over your competitors? Customers are primarily drawn to Core Exterior because of our "Lean Operational Model," which allows us to offer professional-grade service at a price point approximately 20% lower than major franchise competitors like Student Works. Unlike these large franchises, where 30% to 50% of a student manager's profit is diverted to corporate royalties, Core Exterior is 100% independent and locally owned. This structure enables us to pass significant savings directly to the homeowner while still providing the full insurance coverage, WSIB compliance, and reliability expected of a large firm. By eliminating inflated corporate overhead, we position ourselves as a strategic middle ground that offers the safety of a professional corporation without the premium price tag.

What’s different about your product or service? Our service is differentiated by the use of industrial-grade technology and specialized labor that surpasses the retail-grade equipment often used by other student ventures. We have phased out standard pressure washers in favor of high-performance units with X-Jet nozzles and utilize advanced water-fed pole systems and custom-engineered gutter vacuums to clean windows and siding safely from the ground. Furthermore, we do not rely on generalist labor; our technicians are specifically trained in technical tasks such as wood restoration, sanding, and staining, filling a market gap where general landscaping companies lack the craftsmanship to execute these detailed projects effectively.

Are your products or services eco-friendly, energy-efficient, recyclable or ethically sourced? Core Exterior is strictly committed to environmental sustainability and ethical labor practices. We exclusively use phosphate-free and biodegradable cleaning agents that meet the standards of the Ontario Environmental Protection Act, ensuring that our

operations do not harm local ecosystems or client gardens. Operationally, we adhere to the City of London's Water By-law W-8 by utilizing a smart-scheduling system that aligns bookings with the city's even and odd day watering allowances. On the ethical front, we distinguish ourselves from competitors who often burn out staff with seven-day workweeks by enforcing a mandatory "Sunday Rest Day" and guaranteeing a minimum wage top-up to protect our student workforce.

What unique solution are you offering? We offer a "Risk-Free Professionalism" that solves the dilemma homeowners face when choosing between expensive franchises and risky, uninsured independent laborers. While independent operators often undercut pricing by avoiding insurance costs, we educate clients on the significant liability they face by hiring uninsured workers. Core Exterior provides the legal safety net of a fully insured ($2,000,000 liability) and compliant company while maintaining a student-friendly price point. Additionally, our service solves a critical safety problem for our target demographic of seniors and single parents by taking over high-risk tasks—such as servicing third-story gutters—that homeowners can no longer safely perform themselves.

Do you have unique means of distributing your product or service? Our distribution strategy is modernized through a "Digital-First" workflow that replaces traditional manual processes with high-efficiency technology. We utilize artificial intelligence tools to analyze neighborhood demographics, allowing us to scientifically identify the most productive zones for our sales teams to canvass. Once on-site, we have transitioned from pen-and-paper estimates to a proprietary CRM system that enables instant quoting and digital E-signatures, delivering contracts directly to the client's email for immediate approval. This allows for a seamless, paperless customer experience that is significantly faster and more organized than typical student contractors.

Do you offer competitive payment terms or guarantees to your customers? To build trust and financial security, we operate on a "Job-Complete" guarantee, refusing to leave a site until the results meet our strict quality standards. Our payment structure requires a 25% upfront deposit, which financially commits the customer to the schedule while providing the liquidity needed to pay our sales staff instant commissions. We also strictly adhere to the Ontario Consumer Protection Act by offering a 10-day cooling-off period for direct agreements, supported by a "Safe Scheduling" protocol that ensures no labor is deployed until the contract is legally binding, protecting both the client's rights and our operational resources.

02.

Sales and marketing

Identify your key customers and suppliers, how you communicate with them (sales, web, promotions, ongoing support), price and distribute your product or service, and customer support. Use BDC's marketing plan template further to describe your sales and marketing efforts. Include highlights of your marketing plan here. Your text here…

Our primary customers are residential homeowners in the London area, specifically those with homes aged 15-30 years requiring exterior renovation. Our secondary customers are property management firms and small custom home builders who require reliable sub-contracting for exterior envelopes.

Customers

New Home Construction: Homeowners or builders of newly built homes requiring finishing touches like driveway interlock, deck construction, and gutter installation. Affluent Residential Households: Middle-to-high income households who lack the time or technical skill to perform specialized exterior cleaning and maintenance (interlock restoration, gutter cleaning, deck sealing). Commercial & Property Management: Managers of rental buildings, malls, and commercial properties requiring ongoing contract work for exterior upkeep. Is your business reliant on a few primary customers? No. How have you diversified your customer base? Our business is highly diversified across many individual residential projects. No single homeowner accounts for more than 1–5% of our annual revenue. We also balance residential work with commercial contracts (malls, rentals) to ensure stable cash flow.

1	New-Homeowners (post close)	New subdivisions in London area		Driveway Interlock, Decks Gutter Install
2	High-Income Residential	Established Neighborhoods	Payment on Service Delivery	Specialized Cleaning & Maintenance
3	Commercial Property Mgrs	Malls/Rental Complexes		Monthly Maintenance Contracts
4				
Additional information				

Suppliers

We utilize a distributed network of major building supply retailers across London, Ontario. If you depend on a supplier... identify it here: We maintain accounts with Home Depot, Rona, Home Hardware, and Copp's Buildall.

We deliberately utilize multiple locations for each vendor. This strategy ensures that if a specific location is out of stock of a critical "variable cost" (e.g., a specific shade of deck stain or brand of polymeric sand), we can immediately source it from a partner location nearby without delaying the project.

1	Home Depot	3035 Wonderland Rd S, London, ON N6L 1R4, 600 Fanshawe Park Rd E, London, ON N5X 1L1 448 Clarke Rd, London, ON N5W 6H1		Deck Stain, Lumber, polymeric sand and other variable costs.
2	Rona	1335 Fanshawe Park Rd W, London, ON N6G 0E3, 3375 Wonderland Rd S, London, ON N6L 0E3 1282 Hyde Park Rd, London, ON N6H 5K5		
3	Home hardware	1080 Adelaide St N, London, ON N5Y 2N1 136 Wortley Rd, London, ON N6C 3P5 526 Hamilton Rd, London, ON N5Z 1S4		
4	Copp’s Buildall	1640 Fanshawe Park Rd W, London, ON N6H 5K9		

		45 York St, London, ON N6A 1A4 4333 Colonel Talbot Rd, London, ON N6P 1B2 2090 Dundas St, London, ON N5V 1R2		
Additional information				

Advertising and promotion

How are you reaching and selling to customers?

We utilize a multi-channel approach that combines high-trust relationship marketing with aggressive local outreach. Our foundation is built on client retention; we actively mine our database of past customers to secure recurring yearly exterior cleaning contracts, leveraging these trusted relationships to generate high-conversion referrals. To expand beyond our network, we employ a unique "Crew-Sales" model where our labor staff is cross-trained in sales strategies. While active on a job site, our crew canvasses the immediate neighborhood, pitching a "logistical discount"—passing the savings from reduced travel and setup costs directly to neighbors who book immediately. We support this physical presence with a **$5,000 digital marketing budget** allocated to Facebook Ads and PPC campaigns targeting high-income postal codes. Simultaneously, we prioritize Local SEO and our Google Business Profile by posting "Before & After" visual proof from every job, ensuring we rank highly for organic searches. For commercial growth, we utilize LinkedIn to network with property managers, often leveraging our existing residential clients to open doors for B2B maintenance contracts.

What technology and staff resources do you have in place to support your advertising?

To support these efforts, we are investing in specific technology to streamline the transition from "lead" to "completed job." We are currently building or acquiring a specialized Customer Relationship Management (CRM) system to manage client data, ensuring that workflow transitions from quoting to scheduling are efficient and error-free. Because we view organic search traffic as our most valuable long-term asset, we are also dedicating resources to SEO management tools to maintain our ranking on Google Maps. From a staffing perspective, our primary resource is our cross-trained crew. By teaching our service team in-depth sales strategies, we turn every active job site into a revenue-generating hub without incurring the overhead of a separate, dedicated sales force.

Pricing and distribution

What to include here:

- How do you price services or products?
- How do you deliver your product or service?
- Is there anything external that could affect or alter your pricing or delivery?

For deck restoration, our pricing begins at a **Base Rate of $3.00 per square foot**. We then apply three specific variable charges:

1. **Condition Surcharge (Labor):** We assess the deck on a scale of 0–5. For decks in good condition (4–5) requiring minimal prep, we add **$0.05/sq ft**. For decks needing heavy sanding (1–3), we add **$0.15–$0.20/sq ft**. For "Condition 0" areas where wood is rotten, we charge a structural replacement rate of **$12.50 per linear foot** to cover the cost of new pressure-treated lumber and carpentry labor.
2. **Material Grade (Stain):** We adjust the price based on the quality of stain the customer selects. Economy stains (Tier 1–2) add **$0.05/sq ft**, while Premium/High-End stains (Tier 3–5) add **$0.15/sq ft** to cover the increased product cost.
3. **Complexity Factor:** For labor-intensive vertical surfaces like railings and stairs, we add a surcharge of **$0.60** to the base rate to account for the detailed hand-work required.

Gutter & Eaves Maintenance Pricing :

For gutter and eaves cleaning, we utilize a **Tiered Flat-Rate Model** based on building height and accessibility. Our standard service package includes the removal of interior debris (via vacuum or manual removal) and a cosmetic pressure wash of the exterior gutters to improve curb appeal. Pricing is structured as follows: **$200–$350 for 1-story homes**, **$350–$600 for 2-story homes**, and **$500–$850 for 3-story homes**. We also utilize a "Deep Clean" upsell strategy: for clients requesting the *interior* of the gutters be pressure washed (flushed), we apply a surcharge of **$100 base plus $50 per floor** to account for the additional time and water management required.

Interlock Driveway & Path Restoration Pricing

For hardscape restoration, we use a **Condition-Based Pricing Model** that scales according to the structural labor required. Our standard maintenance package (Pressure Wash + Polymeric Sand Refill) is priced at a competitive **Base Rate of $2.05 per square foot**. If the surface requires re-leveling due to ground shifting, we apply a tiered rate adjustment based on the extent of the repair: for minor shifting (3–10 sq. ft.), the total project rate increases to **$2.60/sq. ft.**; for moderate shifting (10–20 sq. ft.), the rate is **$3.25/sq. ft.**; and for significant structural repairs (25–60 sq. ft.), the rate is **$4.10/sq. ft.** to cover the skilled labor of lifting, re-grading, and re-laying stones. Additionally, we offer a protective Sealing finish as a premium add-on, charged as a **flat base fee of $250** plus materials.

Siding Cleaning (Soft Wash) Pricing

For exterior siding cleaning, we utilize a Height + Condition Pricing Model. This ensures we are compensated for both the risk associated with vertical access and the chemical costs required for heavier cleaning. We start with a Base Height Rate to cover mobilization and reach equipment: $250 for 1-story homes, $350 for 2-story homes, and $450 for 3-story homes. On top of this base rate, we add a Condition Fee based on an assessment of organic growth and oxidation (Scale 1–5). For siding in "Good" condition (4–5) requiring a standard wash, we add $150. For siding in "Poor" condition (1–2) with heavy algae or mold, we add $250 to account for the additional chemicals and dwell time required.

Window Cleaning Pricing

For window cleaning, we utilize a **Mobilization + Unit Rate Pricing Model** to ensure profitability on every visit. Every job starts with a **Minimum Service Call Fee of $100**, which covers travel and setup. On top of this base fee, we charge a per-window unit rate based on the scope of work. For **Exterior-Only** service, the rate is **$7.50 per window**. For **Full Service (Interior & Exterior)**, the rate is **$9.50 per window**. This price is all-inclusive, covering the cleaning of the glass, frames, and insect screens, ensuring a comprehensive finish.

Garden Maintenance (Mulching & Weeding) Pricing For softscape services, we utilize a **Premium Volume + Labor Pricing Model** that accounts for the high physical demand of the work and waste disposal costs.

- **Premium Mulch Installation:** We charge **$185.00 per cubic yard** installed. This rate is comprehensive, covering the sourcing of high-grade mulch (Black/Cedar), delivery logistics, and the skilled labor to spread it at the correct depth (2-3 inches) for weed suppression.
- **Weeding & Bed Preparation:** To protect against under-quoting on overgrown properties, we use a **"Starting At" + Hourly Overage Model**:
    - **Zone 1 (Front Yard):** Starts at **$250.00**.
    - **Zone 2 (Back Yard):** Starts at **$450.00**.
    - **Heavy Overgrowth Surcharge:** For properties requiring significant remediation (weeds >6 inches or woody vines), we apply an additional **$85/hour** labor surcharge beyond the base rate.
- **Upsell Services:**

Natural Edge Cutting: We charge **$2.50 per linear foot** to cut a fresh "spade edge" along garden beds, providing a crisp, high-end finish.

Green Waste Disposal: A flat **$65.00 Enviro-Fee** is applied to all weeding jobs to cover the cost of bagging, hauling, and composting the organic waste.

Customer service policy and warranties

Service and Product Guarantee Core Exterior operates on a satisfaction first basis. We do not require final payment for labor until the project is complete and the client has performed a final walkthrough with the Crew Manager. If any

deficiencies are noted during this inspection, such as inconsistent coverage, uneven sanding, or cleanup issues, they are rectified immediately before the job is marked as closed. We further guarantee the use of professional grade materials rather than consumer grade budget products, ensuring that the longevity of the finish matches the quality of our preparation work.

Warranty Policy We provide a formal written warranty to protect our clients against workmanship errors. Core Exterior offers a Two Year Limited Warranty on vertical surfaces such as fences and siding and a One Year Limited Warranty on horizontal deck surfaces. This warranty covers peeling, blistering, and bubbling resulting from improper application or surface preparation. If these issues arise within the warranty period, we will repair the affected areas at no cost to the client. This policy excludes normal fading from UV exposure, physical damage caused by regular use, or pre existing structural rot.

Availability and Contingency Planning Since exterior maintenance is weather dependent, we have structured our operations to minimize disruption. We build specific buffer days into our weekly schedule to accommodate rain without pushing back our entire month's calendar. Priority is always given to completing active jobs before breaking ground on new projects. regarding supply chains, we maintain accounts with multiple local suppliers to ensure material availability. If a specific product is backordered, we have protocols to source chemically equivalent premium alternatives or adjust the schedule immediately to avoid indefinite delays. As a student run enterprise, our full time production capacity runs from May 1st to August 31st. For clients requiring services in September or October, we clearly communicate a modified weekend only schedule during the quoting phase to ensure timelines are realistic and met.

03.

Operating plan

Detail how and where you get your work done. Include equipment and technology required to serve your customers, anticipated financial requirements to maintain and operate your business, and external environmental regulations or laws that govern your business or industry.

Business location

Location:

- **Address:** 203 Cambridge St, London, ON
- **Type:** Home-based Administrative Headquarters & Equipment Storage

Description of Facility: The business operates out of a centralized residential location in London, Ontario. This facility serves a dual purpose:

1. **Administrative Office:** Used for scheduling, bookkeeping, and client communication.
2. **Secure Storage:** On-site storage (garage/secured area) houses all tools, machinery, and inventory when not in use at client sites.

Hours of Operation:

Business Hours: Monday – Saturday, 8:00 AM – 4:00 PM.

Staffing: Crews operate on a standard 8-hour shift structure (7.5 paid working hours with a 30-minute unpaid lunch).

Sunday: Closed.

Impact on Operations & Sales: The location at 203 Cambridge St is strategically situated in central London. This centralization is a logistical advantage, allowing for:

Reduced Travel Time: Equal access to North, South, East, and West London neighborhoods, minimizing crew transit time.

Lower Fuel Costs: Optimized route planning from a central hub reduces daily fuel expenditures.

Rapid Mobilization: The ability to quickly deploy crews and equipment to job sites across the city.

Ownership & Lease Term

Lease Structure: The property is currently under a residential lease agreement valid through **September 2026**.

Financial Advantage: Because the business operates from a leased residence, there is **zero additional commercial rent overhead**. This lean operating model significantly reduces fixed monthly costs compared to competitors renting industrial yard space.

Equipment

Our daily operations rely on a robust fleet of commercial-grade maintenance tools designed for efficiency and high-volume output. The core of our capital assets includes five high-PSI gas-powered pressure washers, which represent our primary startup investment of approximately $3,000. To ensure comprehensive service capabilities, our inventory is further equipped with X-Jet nozzles for chemical injection, commercial extension ladders for height access, and water-fed pole systems for safe, ground-level window cleaning.

We are well-positioned to respond to changing market demands through the versatility of our chosen technology. Specifically, our high-PSI units, combined with X-Jet adjustability, allow us to instantly pivot between heavy-duty concrete restoration and delicate "soft wash" applications for siding or roofs. This adaptability ensures we can service a diverse range of client needs with a single set of machinery. Finally, to maintain lean operations, project-specific consumables—such as paint, stains, and specialized cleaning agents—are managed as variable costs. These are acquired on a "just-in-time" basis tailored to individual customer requirements, preventing unnecessary capital from being tied up in standing inventory.

Technology requirements and investment needs

To maintain a competitive edge and streamline our service delivery, we are prioritizing the development of a proprietary digital infrastructure. Our immediate focus is on securing a professional domain name and deploying a custom-built Customer Relationship Management (CRM) system. By developing this CRM in-house, we are creating a tailored solution that fits our specific scheduling and workflow needs better than generic software, while keeping our ongoing overhead significantly low estimated at just $20 per month for cloud storage and maintenance. While the development of this system represents a time investment, the result will be a scalable cloud-based platform that allows our administrative team and mobile crews to access real-time client data from anywhere. Additionally, we plan to integrate digital payment processing tools to facilitate seamless invoicing and on-site transactions for our customers.

Environmental compliance

Our business is committed to strict compliance with all municipal, provincial, and federal environmental regulations governing the exterior maintenance industry. Primarily, we adhere to the **City of London’s Drainage By-law (WM-4)** and **Wastewater & Stormwater By-law (WM-28)**, ensuring that chemical runoff—specifically from pressure washing and soft-wash applications—is responsibly managed. We utilize diversion techniques to direct wash water onto permeable surfaces (such as lawns or garden beds) rather than allowing chemically treated runoff to enter municipal storm sewers and local waterways.

Additionally, our operations are fully compliant with the **City of London Sound By-law (PW-12)**. By operating strictly between 8:00 AM and 4:00 PM, we fall well within the permitted hours for gas-powered equipment usage (7:00 AM – 10:00 PM), ensuring minimal disruption to residential neighborhoods. From a safety standpoint, all staff members are

trained in **WHMIS (Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System)** standards for the safe handling, storage, and disposal of cleaning agents like sodium hypochlorite. Finally, we actively monitor the **City of London Water By-law (W-8)** and possess the operational flexibility to adjust our water usage protocols during seasonal shortages or municipal drought restrictions.

04.

People

Our success relies on the synergy between our hands-on founding team and experienced external advisors. As a service-based business, our human capital is our most critical asset, combining energetic operational leadership with strategic mentorship to ensure high-quality execution and sustainable growth.

Description of the management team

Name: Mirkomil Oblokulov **Title:** Senior Manager & Founder **Short Bio:** Mirkomil brings a dual background in practical field operations and business strategy. With hands-on experience in the landscaping industry in Ancaster, Ontario, he understands the technical demands of exterior maintenance. Additionally, his extensive background in advising and managing startups provides the strategic oversight necessary to navigate the company's early growth phases. **Key Responsibilities:**

- **Strategic Oversight:** Defining high-level business goals and ensuring all operational activities align with the company vision.
- **Management Supervision:** Directing and auditing the performance of the Field Operations Managers.
- **Operational Assurance:** Implementing systems to ensure workflow efficiency and quality control across all crews.

Name: [To Be Hired/Assigned] (3 Positions) **Title:** Field Operations Managers **Short Bio:** These roles are filled by experienced team leaders capable of bridging the gap between administration and on-site labor. They act as the primary point of contact for daily logistics. **Key Responsibilities:**

- **Logistics & Mobilization:** Ensuring all necessary equipment and machinery are transported to job sites on schedule.
- **Material Procurement:** Managing the purchase and delivery of variable cost materials (paints, stains, chemicals) specific to each client’s project.
- **Personnel Management:** Acting as the first line of defense for staffing issues, including covering shifts for late arrivals or absences to guarantee project timelines are met.

Description of advisory team

External Advisors

Name: David Proudfoot **Title:** Senior Business Advisor / Program Coordinator **Role & Impact:** David serves as our primary external mentor, offering critical oversight on our business strategy and operational planning. We rely on his expertise to:

- **Provide Strategic Guidance:** Assisting with high-level decision-making and answering complex structural questions as we scale.
- **Facilitate Networking:** Acting as a bridge to the broader business community by connecting us with specialized industry experts and resources when specific needs arise.
- **Support Development:** monitoring our progress and ensuring we remain on track with our business milestones.

Key employees

Sales Support: The sales team operates on a condensed schedule (March–April) to front-load the season with bookings. To maximize conversion rates, the Senior Manager acts as a "closer," stepping in to confirm and finalize deals that sales representatives cannot close on their own.

Labor Backup: We mitigate the risk of absenteeism by utilizing our Field Operations Managers as a reserve labor force. If a Labour Technician fails to show up for a shift, a manager is immediately deployed to the site to cover the labor, ensuring that customer appointments are never missed or rescheduled due to staffing issues.

-

1	Sales (20-50)	Responsible for high-volume cold outreach and door-to-door canvassing to generate leads. They qualify homeowners and secure initial interest. If a deal is complex or "unsure," they escalate the closing to the Senior Manager	Strong communication and persuasion skills. Resilience and ability to handle rejection. Must be available for the intensive 2-month acquisition window (March–April).
2	Labour technicains(6-10)	Executing on-site exterior maintenance (pressure washing, soft washing) and setup. Responsible for physical labor, equipment handling, and ensuring job quality meets customer standards.	Physical stamina and ability to lift heavy equipment. Attention to detail. WHMIS certification (training provided) and familiarity with safety protocols.

3			

Additional information

05.

Action plan

The following Action Plan outlines the strategic roadmap for mobilizing a high-volume exterior maintenance operation in London, Ontario. Our execution strategy utilizes a bifurcated approach: an aggressive, front-loaded sales acquisition phase led by a large commission-based team (20–50 representatives), followed by a streamlined service fulfillment phase executed by specialized labor units. By adhering to the strict milestones detailed below, we aim to rapidly scale operations to achieve a break-even point in Month 1 and generate $250,000 in gross revenue within a condensed six-month operational window.

Project objectives

Action Plan

Project Goal To mobilize a high-volume exterior maintenance operation that scales rapidly to achieve **$250,000 in gross revenue** by August 28th. The primary financial objective is to reach a break-even point within the first month of active service through an aggressive, front-loaded sales strategy.

Resources Required

- **Human Capital:**
  - **Sales Force:** A dynamic team of **20–50 Client Acquisition Specialists** (Commission-based) for territory saturation.
  - **Labor Force: 6–10 Field Restoration Technicians**, organized into specialized Service Deployment Units.
  - **Leadership: 3–4 Territory Managers** for operational oversight and quality control.
- **Financial Resources:**
  - Startup capital allocated for equipment acquisition (High-PSI pressure washers, safety gear) and initial marketing collateral.
  - Operating cash flow to sustain logistics until revenue collection begins in April.

Key Milestones & Timeline

- **Phase 1: Leadership & Recruitment (February)**
    - **February 14: Management Onboarding.** Finalize the leadership structure by hiring 3–4 Territory Managers to oversee regional operations.
    - **February 24: Sales Force Assembly.** Complete the recruitment of 20–50 Client Acquisition Specialists. Training focuses on territory mapping, lead qualification, and closing strategies.
- **Phase 2: Market Penetration (March)**
    - **March 7: "Spring Launch."** The sales force initiates the campaign with aggressive direct outreach and cold canvassing. The objective is to build a full project pipeline before weather permits outdoor labor.
- **Phase 3: Fulfillment & Optimization (April – May)**
    - **April 4: Service Deployment.** Onboard and train 6–10 Field Restoration Technicians. These crews immediately begin executing the contracts secured in March.
    - **April – May: Digital Gap-Filling.** Launch a targeted Digital Marketing Campaign to capture online search traffic. This acts as a "Capacity Optimization" mechanism to fill any scheduling gaps left by the direct sales team.
- **Project End Date**
    - **August 28: Fiscal Close.** Service operations conclude for the season, aligning with the end of the student summer term.

Risk Management & Contingencies (Plan B)

- **Labor Reliability Risk:** If Field Technicians are absent or fall behind schedule.
    - *Contingency:* Territory Managers and Senior Leadership are cross-trained to deploy immediately as emergency labor, ensuring no client appointment is cancelled due to staffing shortages.
- **Sales Conversion Risk:** If newer sales representatives struggle to close complex deals.
    - *Contingency:* The Senior Manager will act as a "closer" for high-value or unsure leads confirmed by the sales team, ensuring a higher conversion rate on generated interest.

Resources required

How much money will you require to complete the project?

We require a total capital injection of **$10,000** to reach full operational capacity. This budget is allocated strategically: **$4,000 (40%)** for operational setup and acquiring our initial customer base, **$4,000 (40%)** for working capital to float labor costs, and **$2,000 (20%)** for essential equipment upgrades and maintenance.

How much will you finance yourself?

The founding team is self-financing the project through **sweat equity** and the provision of **existing assets**. We are maximizing the value of the equipment inventory acquired during our pilot year (including pressure washers, basic

ladders, and hand tools), which drastically reduces the hard cash requirement for startup. The external funding is strictly reserved for scaling operations and cash flow management.

Will you require new equipment or real estate?

Real Estate: No. We do not require commercial real estate financing. Operations are based out of our leased residence at 203 Cambridge St, utilizing on-site storage to eliminate overhead costs.

Equipment: Yes. While we utilize existing assets, we have allocated **$2,000** to acquire specialized technology to remain competitive. This includes **X-Jet chemical injection systems** for soft-washing and **water-fed pole assemblies** for ladder-free window cleaning, allowing us to bid on higher-value, multi-story projects.

Do you need to hire new people? Yes.

To achieve our revenue target of $250,000, we are executing a massive seasonal recruitment drive.

> **Sales Force:** We are hiring **20–50 commission-based Client Acquisition Specialists** to execute our territory saturation strategy in March.
>
> **Labor Force:** We are hiring **6–10 Field Restoration Technicians** to form our specialized Service Deployment Units.
>
> **Management:** We are onboarding **3 Territory Managers** to oversee quality control and logistics.

Risk assessment and contingencies

.Timeline Triggers & Schedule Management The primary threat to our timeline is inclement weather, which can trigger a "domino effect" where one delayed job pushes back the entire weekly schedule.

- **Mitigation Strategy (The Sunday Buffer):** We have intentionally left **Sunday** open as a non-operating day. This serves as our designated "spillover" day to reschedule weather-affected jobs immediately, preventing delays from bleeding into the following week.
- **Managerial Intervention:** In the event of severe backlogs where Sunday is insufficient, our Field Operations Managers will step in to complete labor tasks personally, ensuring the schedule gets back on track without disrupting future client bookings.

Personnel & Leadership Readiness

- **Leadership:** Senior Manager Mirkomil Oblokulov is directly responsible for the rigorous selection of the management team, ensuring that only leaders with proven problem-solving skills are placed in charge of logistics.
- **Employee Quality:** We mitigate operational risk at the source by prioritizing "Character-First" hiring. We screen specifically for honesty and punctuality to ensure we have a reliable workforce that minimizes no-shows and on-site errors.

Cash Flow & Financial Risks Our cash flow model is designed to self-fund the most immediate expenses, reducing financial risk.

- **Deposit Structure:** We require an upfront deposit from clients. This capital is immediately used to cover **Sales Team commissions** and **Material costs**, ensuring these variable expenses are paid for before work begins.
- **Labor Coverage:** The remaining balance collected upon job completion is used to pay Field Technicians and Managers.

- **Safety Net:** As a final layer of protection, we have allocated **$4,000 in working capital float**. This allows us to meet payroll obligations for our workers even if a client's final payment is slightly delayed.

Mechanical Risks We acknowledge the risk of mechanical failure with our pressure washing equipment. To mitigate this, we maintain spare units and have managers capable of performing field repairs or swapping equipment to keep crews operational.

(Sales & Revenue) If the sales force underperforms or falls behind quota:

- **Direct Intervention:** The Senior Manager will personally step in to close high-value or "unsure" leads that the sales team cannot finalize.
- **Marketing Shift:** We will immediately reallocate budget funds to the Digital Marketing campaign to drive inbound lead generation and fill any gaps in the schedule.

Business Plan

company.ca